

whacks off the newly budded flowers in front of Bushwood's clubhouse. He uses plastic explosives to kill gophers. Carl lusts after matronly lady golfers as if they were Dallas Cowboy cheerleaders in heat.

In one scene Carl tells a young co-worker about the time he caddied for the Dalai Lama in Tibet. "Big hitter, the Lama," says Carl. "Long. So the round's over, and the Lama's going to *stiff* me. So I tell him, 'Hey, Lama. How's about something . . . you know . . . for the effort. You know.'"

"So the Lama says, 'There won't be any money. But when you die, on your deathbed, you will achieve total consciousness.'"

Carl gets a self-satisfied, superior smirk on his face. "So I've got that going for me. Which is nice."

Carl's "wait'll you die" approach works for disturbed greenskeepers and many others as well. But for me, "wait'll you die" seems as unsatisfying as "keep your head down." I need a more positive approach.

GO FOR RESPONSIBLE PLEASURE

When I retired I had the sensation of moving from the "real" world to a more playful, almost make-believe world. The world hadn't changed, only my point of view. When my job was the center of things, work was a given, like certain accounting principles. I took my job seriously and viewed life from the vantage point of an executive. That was the "real" world.

But what happened when I left the job? It was like going from Newtonian to modern physics. Newton explained the "real" world of gravity and its effect on planets. Modern physicists, on the other hand, explain a playful, make-believe world. In it particles don't behave as they ought to. Particles move around based on probabilities rather than "natural" laws. They change size when they move, they jump around in sudden, quantum leaps, they can even be in two places at the same time.